

1 **HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES - FLOOR VERSION**

2 STATE OF OKLAHOMA

3 2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

4 COMMITTEE SUBSTITUTE
5 FOR
6 HOUSE BILL NO. 2398

By: Hill of the House

and

7 **Reinhardt** of the Senate

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10 COMMITTEE SUBSTITUTE

11 An Act relating to education; defining terms;
12 authorizing the State Regents for Higher Education
13 and the Department of Career and Technology Education
14 to designate a credential of value; listing criteria
15 for a credential of value; permitting the designation
16 of a credential of value if the credential is
17 determined to be essential to meeting documented
18 state workforce needs; authorizing the State Regents
19 and the Department to adopt a definition of self-
20 sufficient wage; authorizing the State Regents and
21 the Department to promulgate rules and determine
22 procedures to implement the section; requiring annual
23 report from institutions, agencies, and schools on
24 data required to evaluate credentials under this
 section; requiring the State Regents and the
 Department to annually publish a statewide credential
 of value list; authorizing the State Regents and the
 Department to enter into data-sharing agreements; and
 providing for codification.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 1. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 9201 of Title 70, unless there is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

A. As used in this section:

1. "Coordinating entity" means the Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education or the Oklahoma Department of Career and Technology Education;

2. "Credential of value" means a certificate, degree, license, industry-recognized credential, apprenticeship credential, or other postsecondary or career-technical award issued by an educational provider that meets the criteria established under this section;

3. "Educational provider" means any institution, agency, or school coordinated by the Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education or governed by the Oklahoma Department of Career and Technology Education; and

4. "Net cost of attendance" means the cost of attendance minus all grants, scholarships, fee waivers, or other aid received by the individual.

B. A coordinating entity may designate a credential as a credential of value if the credential satisfies the following criteria:

1. The credential provides a positive return on investment for individuals who complete the credential, demonstrated by:

1 a. cumulative earnings within a time period specified by
2 the coordinating entity that coordinates or governs
3 the educational provider that are equal to or exceed
4 the statewide median earnings for Oklahoma high school
5 graduates, and

6 b. earnings that allow the credential holder to recoup
7 the net cost of attendance within a time period
8 specified by the coordinating entity that coordinates
9 or governs the educational provider; and

10 2. The credential is aligned with state and regional labor
11 market demand, as determined by the coordinating entity that
12 coordinates or governs the educational provider, using data from the
13 Oklahoma Employment Security Commission, the Oklahoma Workforce
14 Commission, or other labor market sources recognized by the
15 coordinating entity.

16 C. A coordinating entity may designate a credential as a
17 credential of value even if it does not meet one or more criteria
18 under subsection B of this section if the credential is determined
19 by the coordinating entity to be essential to meeting documented
20 state workforce needs.

21 D. A coordinating entity may adopt a definition of a self-
22 sufficient wage for purposes of this section that aligns with:

23 1. Statewide self-sufficiency wage benchmarks; or
24

1 2. Regional economic and labor market data that reflect the
2 cost of living and labor market conditions in Oklahoma.

3 E. A coordinating entity may promulgate rules and determine
4 procedures to implement the provisions of this section, including:

5 1. Standard methodologies for calculating return on investment
6 and net cost of attendance;

7 2. Criteria and data sources for assessing alignment with
8 workforce demand;

9 3. A unified statewide process for designating and periodically
10 reviewing credentials of value; and

11 4. A shared reporting structure and timeline for all education
12 providers under the coordination or governance of the coordinating
13 entity.

14 F. 1. Each educational provider shall annually report the data
15 required to evaluate credentials under this section to the
16 coordinating entity that coordinates or governs the educational
17 provider. Such data shall include, but is not limited to, the
18 following:

19 a. enrollment, completion, and credential attainment,

20 b. graduate employment rate and earnings outcomes, and

21 c. program cost information.

22 2. A coordinating entity shall annually publish a statewide
23 credential of value list, accessible to the public, identifying all
24 credentials designated under this section.

1 G. A coordinating entity may enter into data-sharing agreements
2 with the Oklahoma Employment Security Commission, the Oklahoma
3 Workforce Commission, and other state agencies to support the
4 evaluation and designation of credentials of value.

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6 COMMITTEE REPORT BY: COMMITTEE ON EDUCATION OVERSIGHT, dated
7 03/04/2026 - DO PASS, As Amended and Coauthored.
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